

TRANSITS

You have come across the terms such as Astakavarga, Gocara (or transit) etc. I should like to tell you something about this Gocara before proceeding further. The word Gocara simply means movement of planets along the circle of the zodiac. Though the word Go means cow, ray etc. here it stands for planets that are possessed of rays or lustre. You have already seen how a planet produces effects, good or bad, during its Dasa. This Dasa-methodology is based upon the natal chart as a whole. The Gocara-system, however, is based upon the transit or movement of planets from time to time through the various Signs of the zodiac starting, of course, from a fixed point viz. the position of the natal Moon. No doubt there are important factors in a horoscope viz. the Ascendant, the Moon's Sign and the one occupied by the Sun. So the effects of transit must be considered with reference to all these three factors. Still the ancients have given greater weight and consideration to the Moon's position at birth. The reason for this is not far to seek. For, the Moon is the Cosmic Mind or the one born of the mind of the Supreme. Historically too her importance cannot be minimized, as her phases were observed by men in the dim past and were connected by them with their vicissitudes and changes in weather etc. Again, it is the mind that is responsible for the happiness and misery of man. When the mind is content, even a beggar does not fear a king. When such is the case, it is but right that the Moon should be considered as the pivot for the changing fortunes of all beings. Moreover, in the case of this Gocara system generally the planets as such are considered and not as owners of Bhavas. So if you want to apply this system with the Sun or Lagna as the starting point, you should not say that this or that planet is good or bad in such and such houses counted from the Sun or Lagna. But you have to consider the planets as lords of houses (counted of course from either the Sun or Lagna) transiting the various Bhavas from either. Now I shall give the details of the usual Gocara system. Taking the natal Moon as the starting point you have to proceed to consider which planets are-

good or bad and in which houses. In this case too you must be exact and scientific in your method. For this purpose you must make a new Bhava chart with the longitude of the Moon at birth as the Lagna. If this is done properly, you can say whether a planet in transit is in one or another house from the Moon. • For example, let us suppose that the Moon is in the 29th degree of Mesha. If the Sun in transit comes to the 4th degree of Vrsabha, you should not think that the Sun is in the 2nd house from the Moon. He should be considered to be in the first house itself. The Sun produces good effects when he passes in transit through the 3rd, 6th, 10th and 11th houses from the Moon. So the effects of his transit through the other house are to be understood to be bad. Similarly Mars, Saturn, Rahu and Ketu produce good effects only in the 3rd, 6th and 11th houses from the Moon. The Moon is beneficial in 1, 3, 6, 7, 10 and 11 places from herself. Mercury is auspicious in 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 and 11 places from the Moon. Jupiter is good in 2, 5, 7, 9 and 11 places. Venus is favourable in 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9, 11 and 12 places.

Generally the nine planets beginning with the Sun take respectively the following periods to pass through a Rasi : (1) 1 month; (2) 2.1/4 days; (3) 2 months; (4) 1 month; (5) 1 year; (6) 1 month; (7) 2.1/2 years; (8) and (9) 1.1/2 years. Though a planet is expected to produce its effects, good or bad, throughout the period of its passage over a house, still it has a particular part of that period which is considered most potent. They are respectively for the planets beginning with the Sun (1) the first 5 days; (2) the last 3 Ghatis; (3) the first 8 days; (4) throughout the period of 1 month;

(5) 2 months in the middle; (6) 7 days in the middle; (7) the last six months; (8) & (9) | the last 3 months. The same idea may be put in another form } as follows :— The Sun and Mars produce effects when they pass through the initial 10 degrees of a Rasi, Jupiter and Venus in the | middle 10 degrees, the Moon and Saturn in the last 10 degrees, | and Mercury and Rahu throughout their passage. |

It is true that there are varieties of good and bad effects which | I am going to explain shortly. But before I take up that task | I should like to tell you some other detail about this. It is what is called VEDHA, which means *piercing* in literal parlance»! but here "undoing" or "cancellation". For every place producing good or bad effects there is a place called Vedha which when occupied by some other planet nullifies the previous effects. For example, the Sun is good in transit when he passes through the 3rd house, but its Vedha is the 9th house. The idea is that although the Sun transiting the 3rd house from the natal Moon should yield very good results, still there would be nothing good coming out of this position if at that time some planet (other than Saturn) transits the 9th house from the Moon. In the same manner bad effects too are nullified by their Vedha positions being tenanted by some other planets at the same time. The following table gives the Vedha positions of all the planets :

Table of Vedha

Planets	I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII	VIII	IX	X	XI	XII			
	houses														
Sun	1	2	9		3	6	12	7 8	10	4	5	11			
Moon		5	1	9	3	6	12	2	7	10	4	8	11		
Mars	I	2	12	3	4		9	6	7	8	10	5	11		
Mercury			2	5	4	3		7	9	6	1	8	10	12	11
Jupiter			1	12	2	5	4	6	3	7	10	9	8		11
Venus			8	7	1	10	9	12	2	5	11	4	3	6	

Explanation :—Under I against the Sun you see the number 1 for Vedha. What does it mean ? It means that when the Sun passes through the natal Moon at any time if there is some other planet transiting the same Rasi i.e. there is some other planet with the Sun, at the time, the effects (here, bad) are cancelled. Similarly in the case of the second house.

The Vedha positions of *Saturn* and *Ketu* are the same as those of Mars. An important exception to the Vedha-rule is that it does not operate in the case of planets that are related as father and son. For example, there is no Vedha between the Sun and Saturn as they are respectively father and son. So too there is no Vedha between the Moon and Mercury. The idea is that in the case *pf* the Sun even if a Vedha position be occupied by Saturn, there would not be any cancellation of the previous effects.

Now I intend telling you in detail the effects of Gocara or • transit of the several planets through the twelve houses counted ^ from the Sign occupied by the Moon at birth. When the *Sun* ;

passes through the *First* house (the Sign tenanted by the natal I Moon), the following bad effects will be experienced :— Fatigue, loss of money, irritability, illness and wearisome journeys. When he transits the *Second* house, there will be loss of wealth, unhappiness, chance of being deceived and avarice. When he passes through the *Third* house, there will be acquisition of i a good position, very handsome income, happiness, good ' . health and destruction of enemies. When he passes through the *Fourth* house, the native will suffer from ailments, will be unhappy and be deprived of the company of his wife and kinsmen. When the same planet transits the *Fifth* house, there will be mental agitation, frequent illness, delusion etc. When he transits the *Sixth* house, there will be an end of ailments, enemies, grief and delusion. When he passes through the *Seventh* house, the subject will undertake

wearisome journeys; he will have illness caused by stomach and anus troubles; he will also be subjected to humiliation. When he transits the *Eighth* house, there will be illness, fear, quarrels, troubles from the King or government and excessive heat. When he passes through the *Ninth* house, there will be danger, humiliation, separations from one's relatives and mental agony. His passage through the *Tenth* house will enable the subject to accomplish a mighty undertaking. His passage through the *Eleventh* house will help the native to acquire a good position, honour, wealth and cure of diseases. His transit through the *Twelfth* house will produce great strain, loss of wealth, quarrel with friends and fever. The *Moon* will produce the following effects when she passes through the 12 houses counted from her natal position :—

(1) Rise of fortune, (2) loss of money, (3) success, (4) fear, (5) ^ sorrow, (6) sound health, (7) all kinds of happiness, (8) untoward ' events, (9) sickness, (10) attainment of desired objects, (11) joy, and (12) expenditure. Mars will give the following effects when he passes through the 12 houses :—(!) mental grief, separation from one's kith and kin and diseases caused by the vitiation of blood and bile as well as those caused by excessive heat.

(2) When he passes through the *Second* house, there will be fear, indiscreet words or verbal warfare and loss of wealth.

(3) In the *Third* he will give rise to victory, acquisition of gold ornaments and great joy.

(4) In the *Fourth* he causes loss of position, illness of the stomach and sorrow on account of kinsmen. (5) In the *Fifth* house he will create fever, improper desire or thoughts, sorrow on account of children and quarrels with one's relatives. (6) When he passes through the *Sixth* house, there will be cessation of enmities and quarrels, recovery from sickness, victory, financial gain and success in all undertakings. (7) In the *Seventh* house he causes misunderstandings with one's wife, eye-disease and stomach-trouble. (8) In the *Eighth* house there will be fever, bleeding and loss of wealth and honour. (9) In the *Ninth* there will be humiliation caused by loss of wealth etc., and retarded gait through physical weakness and loss of vitality. (10) In the *Tenth* house he causes wicked activities, obstacles to one's projects, and physical strain. (11) In the *Eleventh* house he produces wealth, health and addition to landed property. (12) Lastly in the *Twelfth* house he engenders loss of wealth, excessive heat, fever etc.

Mercury brings about the following effects in order when he passes through the 12 houses beginning with the Janma Rasi :— (1) Loss of money, (2) wealth, (3) fear of enemies, (4) acquisition of wealth (5) quarrel with one's wife and children, (6) victory, <7) obstruction, (8) begetting children and earning money, (9) impediments, (10) all-round happiness, (11) progress, and (12) fear of defeat.

Jupiter causes the following effects while transiting the 12 houses in order :— (1) Quitting one's birth-place, loss of wealth and hostility. (2) Gain of wealth, family happiness and effectiveness of one's words. (3) Loss of position, separation from the near and dear ones, illness and impediments to one's work. (4) Sorrow on account of relatives, humiliation and danger from quadrupeds. (5) Birth of a son, association with the virtuous and royal favour. (6) Trouble from enemies and one's own relatives and diseases. (7) Good journey for auspicious purposes, conjugal happiness and birth of a son. (8) Fatigue through needless journeys, illluck, loss of money, and miseries. <9) All-round prosperity and joy as well as happiness and good fortune. (10) Trouble to one's property, position, children etc. (11) Acquisition of children, position, honour etc. (12) •Grief and danger to wealth. *Venus* produces the following effects in the 12 houses :— (1) Enjoyment of all kinds of pleasures. (2) Financial gain. (3) Progress and prosperity. (4) Increase of happiness and friends. (5) Birth of children. (6) Adversity. (7) Trouble to wife. (8) Wealth. (9) Happiness. (10) Quarrel. (11) Safety and security. (12) Good income.

Saturn is supposed to bring about the following effects in the 12 houses :— (1) Illness and performance of funeral rites. (2) Trouble to wealth and children. (3) Acquisition of position, wealth and servants. (4) Loss of wife, relatives and wealth. (5)

Decline of prosperity, children and mental powers. (6) All-round happiness. (7) Sickness of one's wife, long journeys and fear. (8) Loss of children, cattle, friends and wealth, and sickness. (9) Poverty, obstacles to the performance of religious rites, death of an elder equal to the father, and continuous misery.

(10) Interest in forbidden activities, loss of honour, and sickness.

(11) All kinds of happiness, acquisition of many kinds of wealth and unique renown.

(12) Fatigue owing to worthless business, loss of wealth through enemies, and illness of wife and children.

Rahu produces the following effects while passing through the 12 houses :— (1) Death or serious illness. (2) Loss of wealth. (3) Happiness. (4) Sorrow. (5) Loss of money. (6) Happiness. (7) Loss. (8) Danger to life. (9) Loss. (10) Gain. (11) Happiness (12) Loss. The effects of the transits of Ketu are the same as those of Rahu. There is one common feature that is found among the four planets viz. the Sun, Mars, Jupiter and Saturn. That is, when these transit through the 12th, 8th, and the 4th houses, they tend to produce danger to life, and loss of position and wealth. The following point also should be noted with regard to the transits of the Moon, Mars, Rahu, Venus, Jupiter, the Sun, Saturn and Mercury :— When the Moon passes through the 8th house, Mars through the 7th, Rahu through the 9th, Venus through the 6th, Jupiter through the 3rd, the Sun through the 5th, Saturn through the 1st house, and Mercury through the 4th, there is every likelihood of loss of wealth and honour, and death.

Nakyaatra-Gocara :— Connected with the subject of Gocara or planetary transits there is a method of finding out whether a particular period is favourable or not. This is done by noting the nature of the star occupied by the Sun in transit and its relationship with one's natal asterism and some other stars which bear close kinship with that. For *this* purpose a diagram is needed, which is called the *Saptasalaka-Cakra*. In this figure what you have to do is that you should draw seven horizontal lines and seven vertical lines crossing the previous ones. While drawing the lines see that the ends of all the lines jut out so that you may get 28 points. In this scheme there is one more asterism called Abhijit which comes in between Uttarasadha and Sravana. The first asterism that should be written at the point in the North-eastern corner is Krttika. So the last will be Bharani. Now look at the figure on page 252 for clarification.

Now you must know how to read from this diagram whether there is any untoward transit of the Sun with regard to the natal star etc. In this figure you note that some stars face one another. For example, Krttika and Sravana, Aslesa and Anuradha, Bharani and Magha, Dhanistha and Visakha. This means there is mutual affliction or *Vedha* between these two stars. The idea is that if the natal star is Krttika and if the Sun transits at the time the star Sravana, you have to conclude that there is trouble in store for the native. In this connection you are required to remember some more technical terms : The natal star is called Janma-naksatra, the second one from that is Sampat or wealth, the 3rd is Vipat or danger, the 4th is Ksema or happiness, the 5th one is Pratyak (Pratyra) or obstruction, the 6th one is Sadhana or achievement, the 7th one is Nidhana or death, the 8th is Maitra or friendly, the 9th is Paramamaitra or very friendly, the 10th is Karma or action, the 11th is Adhana or depositing and the 12th is Vainasika or destructive. So if on a particular day or period the Sun is transiting a star which happens to be the Vedha one for one's natal asterism, then it is to be inferred that there is danger to the native's life. Suppose the star occupied at the time by the Sun happens to be the Vedha not for the natal star but for the Adhana star i.e. the 11th one from the natal star, then the effect would be fear and anxiety. Let us suppose your natal star to be Mrgasiras. Then its Vedha is Uttarasadha. If the Sun is transiting Uttarasadha, you have to think that there is danger to life. On the other hand, if the Sun is passing through not Uttarasadha but through Visakha, which is the Vedha for the star that is 11th from the natal star viz. Dhanistha (it becomes the Adhana), there will

East							
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Bharai?i							
Asvini							P. Phalga
Revati							U. Phalgu
U. Bhadra							Hasta
P. Bhadra							Citra
Satabhisak							Svati
Dhanistha							Visakha
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West

be fear. Similarly if the star tenanted by the Sun happens to be Vedha for Karma-star i.e. 10th from the natal one, there will be loss of money. In addition to the above if the Sun is also conjoined with a malefic, death will be the result. In the same manner see also if other malefics, (i.e. other than the Sun) occupy in transit stars which are Vedha for the three stars viz. the natal one, the 10th and the 19th. In such a case too the result will be death. If both malefics and benefics transit such stars, there will be no danger to life. There is yet another way of finding out bad effects of transit :

If malefics should transit the natal star, the 3rd from it, the 5th, the 7th, 10th, 19th or the 23rd (all counted from the natal star), then too there will be danger to life. If these positions are occupied by benefics in transit, then there will be only failure of undertakings. Now you see that this is another kind of Vedha different from the one indicated by the Saptasaiaka figure. Remember also that this is different from the Rasi-procedure and its Vedha which have been already explained. The 10th and 19th stars counted from the natal asterism are also called respectively Anujanma and Trijanma. This means that the 10th is the natal star in the second round and the 19th in the third round. See also if the natal star in any round synchronizes with the Sun's entry into another Sign of the zodiac. If it does, then the effect is very bad. It may be death or great danger to

life. The same effect will take place, if the same natal star in any round happens to synchronize with the change of sign of any other planet, or with an eclipse, planetary war, falling of meteors or with any other extra-ordinary event.

There are some more points to be remembered in this connection : You have understood now as to which planets give unfavourable results and in which stars and signs. This is not all. Even if a planet is found to be capable of yielding unfavourable results on account of its transit, the bad effects will be nullified by the aspect of a benefic on that planet. The same argument holds good in the case of a planet supposed to produce excellent results but aspected by a malefic. Similar is the effect in the case of one aspected by its enemy. So while pronouncing judgment on Gocara effects you should be extremely cautious. It is not enough if you simply note the basic rule regarding good and bad houses for the planets in transit. Even if a planet occupies a very bad house according to the rules of transit, it cannot give bad effects in case it occupies at the time its own house or its exaltation. On the other hand, it will yield most excellent results when it transits a good house which is its own house or its exaltation. You have also to note if a planet in transit is in its debilitation, inimical house or combustion. In such a condition even the good effects that are expected would not materialize, and the bad effects would be greatly aggravated.

There is yet another method of finding out the Gocara effects from the limbs of the native occupied by the planets. Certain stars counted from the natal one are assigned to different limbs of the person. For example, in the case of the Sun's transit the natal star is called the Face. So if the Sun transits the natal

star of a person, he is supposed to be seated on the face of the native. The effect of this is not at all happy. I am tabulating below for your convenience the stars constituting the limbs and their effects in the case of the *Sun* and other planets separately.

Sun

Stars

- (a) First star or the natal star
- (b) 2nd, 3rd, 4th and 5th
- (c) 6th, 7th, 8th and 9th.
- (d) 10th, 11th, 12th and 13th
- (e) 14th, to 19th (six stars)
- (f) 20th to 23rd (four stars)
- (g) 24th and 25th (h) 26th and 27th

Note that here the counting star, and not from Asvini.

Stars

- (a) 1st and 2nd
- (b) 3rd to 6th (four)
- (c) 7th and 8th
- (d) 9th and 10th
- (e) 11th to 15th (five)
- (f) 16th, 17th and 18th
- (g) 19th to 24th (six) (h) 25th, 26th and 27th

Stars

- (a) 1st and 2nd
- (b) 3rd to 8th (six)
- (c) 9th, 10th, 11th
- (d) 12th to 15th (four)
- (e) 16th and 17th
- (f) 18th to 21st (four)
- (g) 22nd to 25th (four) (h) 26th and 27th

Limbs Face Head Chest

Right hand The feet Left hand The eyes Genital organ is done always

Effects

Destruction Great prosperity Victory Wealth Poverty
Physical ailments Gain
Danger to life from one's natal
Moon

<i>Limbs</i>	<i>Effects</i>
Face	Great fear
Head	Happiness
Back	Victory over foes
Eyes	Financial gain
Heart	Happiness
Left hand	Hatred
Feet	Going abroad
Right hand	Financial gain

Mars

<i>Limbs</i>	<i>Effects</i>
Face	Death
Feet	Fighting
Chest	Success
Left hand	Indigence
Head	Gain
Face	Excessive fear
Right hand	Happiness' ,
Eyes	Going away .., from home u

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Mercury, Jupiter and Venus

Stars <a) 1st, 2nd, 3rd <b) 4th, 5th, 6th
(c) 7th to 12th (six)
(d) 13th to 17th (five)
(e) 18th and 19th
<f) 20th to 27th (eight)

Limbs
Head
Face
Hands
Belly
Genital
organ Feet

Stars (a) 1st star
<b) 2nd to 5th (four) (c) 6th, 7th and 8th <d) 9th, 10th & 11th

Saturn, Rahu and Ketu

Limbs Face
Right hand Right foot Left foot
(e) 12th to 15th (four)
(f) 16th to 20th (five)
(g) 21st, 22nd, 23rd (h) 24th and 25th (i) 26th and 27th

Effects Sorrow Gain Disaster

Plenty of wealth Loss or
destruction Fame and
position

Effects

Grief

Happiness

Travel

Loss or

destruction

Gain Enjoyments Happiness Happiness Death

Left hand

Belly

Head

Eyes

Back *Latta* :— This word Latta means Vedha or affliction. It appears to be of foreign origin like Kriya for Aries, Tavuru for Taurus etc. This means, as far as transit is concerned, that a planet transiting a particular asterism afflicts another asterism occurring at a particular distance. This distance is measured in the forward direction in some cases and in the opposite direction in the case of others. The former is called Purolatta and the latter Prsthalatta. To the former group belong the Sun, Mars, Jupiter and Saturn, and to the latter the Moon, Mercury, Venus and Rahu. In the case of the Sun the Latta on the 12th asterism counted in the regular order from the one occupied by him at the time. The idea is that if the Sun is now passing through the star Uttara Phalgum, the Latta will fall on Dhanistha. So if Dhanistha happens to be the natal star of a person, he will have illness and sorrow as the effect of this affliction. In the case of Mars the Latta—forward—falls on the 3rd star. Now he is in the asterism Mrgaslrša. So the

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Latta falls on Punarvasu. Hence it should be inferred that a person whose natal star is Punarvasu is likely to fare ill at this time. In the case of Jupiter the Latta — forward —falls on the 6th star. As Jupiter is now in Mula, his Latta falls on Satabhisak. In the case of Saturn it falls on the 8th star. As he is now in Purvasadha, his Latta will fall on Revati. In the case of the Moon the *backward* Latta would fall on the 22nd star. So if the Moon be in Rohini today, her Latta would be on Magha, because here the counting is done backwards. In the case of Mercury it will fall on the 7th star counted backwards. So if Mercury be now in the star Hasta, then his Latta would be on Punarvasu. So the transit of Mercury becomes unfavourable to a person whose natal star is Punarvasu. In the case of Venus it falls on the fifth star counted backwards. If Venus is in Citra now, his Latta will be on Magha. Lastly the Latta of Rahu falls on the 9th asterism counted backwards. So if Rahu is transiting the star P. Phalguni, its Latta will be on Krttika. If the natal star comes under the Latta of two or more planets, the bad effects will be greatly enhanced. Though the general effect of Latta has been given as trouble, yet different effects are given for the different planets producing the Latta. The effect of the Sun's Latta is loss of one's entire effects, the Moon's great loss, Mars' utter ruination, Mercury's fall and disaster, Jupiter's death, ruin of relatives and insecurity, Venu's quarrel, Saturn's the same as that of the Sun, and lastly that of Rahu and Ketu misery.